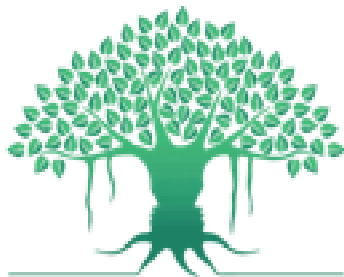


Magic of zero

Failure and success, Two sides of the same coin. **Sounds cliched**, but stick with me for a second. We **often** treat failure like **a dead-end**. A painful **reminder** that something did not **work out** the way we hoped. It is not a dead-end, but a **nudge** in a different direction. Like a redirect button on Google Maps. We wanted to go left, but life **whispered**, 'Nope, turn right! There's something better waiting.'

Yes, in that moment, our confidence **dips**, and we start doubting our own journey. But we must give it time. If not this, then something even better usually **shows up**. It is **strange** how **hindsight** reveals beauty of **detours**. The real problem is not failure - it is how we have been taught to define it.

Society's **perception** of success is often closely tied to bank balance, title, house or followers. In that case, many would still call you 'unsuccessful'. And that's the **irony**. Because zero is a magic number, it is not empty. It is powerful. Add a zero to 1 and you get ₹10. This is the beauty of zero; it **amplifies**. So, instead of **resisting** zero, why not **embrace** it? Maybe it's a **reset** you didn't know you needed.



THE SPEAKING TREE

Success and failure are not destinations. They are not **labels** to **stick** on our **foreheads**. They are moments: **fleeting**, shifting, evolving. Sometimes, failure brings **wisdom**. Sometimes, success brings silence, and in both, there's value. We are not our failures. We are not our wins. We are the **soul** **navigating** through both.

[Practice Exercise]

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

Vocabulary

1. **Sound** (verb) – seem, appear, come across as, ring, feel लगना
2. **Cliché** (verb) – overuse, stereotype, make trite, banalize, trivialize घिसा-पिटा बना देना
3. **Often** (adverb) – frequently, regularly, repeatedly, commonly, routinely अक्सर
4. **A dead-end** (noun) – cul-de-sac, impasse, blind alley, stalemate, deadlock बंद गली
5. **Reminder** (noun) – prompt, nudge, cue, recollection, memo याद दिलावन
6. **Work out** (phrasal verb) – succeed, pan out, turn out, come off, materialize सफल होना
7. **Nudge** (noun) – gentle push, prod, prompt, cue, shove हल्का धक्का
8. **Whisper** (verb) – murmur, mutter softly, breathe, say quietly, hint फुसफुसाना
9. **Dip** (verb) – decline, drop, wane, sag, ebb घटना
10. **Show up** (phrasal verb) – appear, turn up, emerge, arrive, surface प्रकट होना
11. **Strange** (adjective) – odd, peculiar, unusual, curious, uncanny अजीब
12. **Hindsight** (noun) – retrospect, afterthought, retrospective insight, second thoughts, post-fact understanding पश्चदृष्टि
13. **Detour** (noun) – diversion, bypass, deviation, sidetrack, roundabout route विकल्प मार्ग
14. **Perception** (noun) – view, perspective, outlook, notion, understanding धारणा
15. **Irony** (noun) – paradox, incongruity, contradiction, sardonic twist, wryness विडंबना
16. **Amplify** (verb) – increase, magnify, boost, augment, intensify बढ़ाना
17. **Resist** (verb) – oppose, withstand, defy, fight, refuse विरोध करना
18. **Embrace** (verb) – accept, adopt, welcome, espouse, take on अपनाना
19. **Reset** (noun) – fresh start, reboot, restart, do-over, new beginning नई शुरुआत
20. **Label** (noun) – tag, designation, epithet, category, stamp ठप्पा
21. **Stick** (verb) – attach, affix, glue, paste, adhere चिपकाना
22. **Forehead** (noun) – brow, frontal, browline, front, frontal region माथा

23. **Fleeting** (adjective) – momentary, transient, brief, ephemeral, passing
क्षणभंगुर

24. **Wisdom** (noun) – insight, prudence, sagacity, discernment, understanding
विवेक

25. **Soul** (noun) – spirit, inner self, essence, being, psyche आत्मा

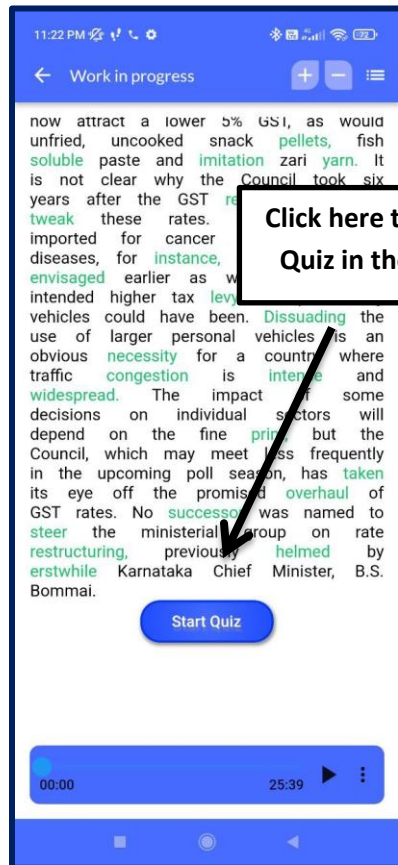
26. **Navigate** (verb) – steer, negotiate, work through, find one's way, chart a course
राह निकालना

@mocks_wallah

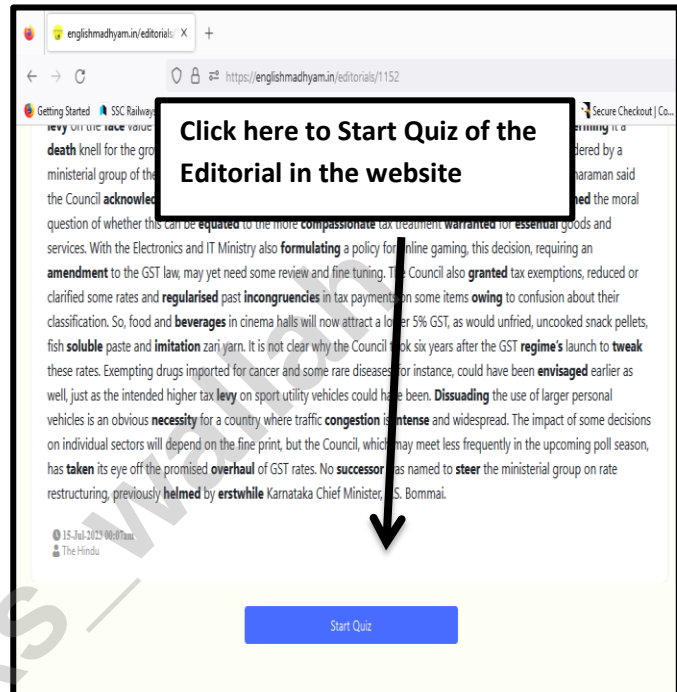
Summary of the Editorial

1. Failure and success are often seen as opposites but are really two sides of the same coin.
2. Failure is not a dead-end; it is a *redirection*, like being rerouted on Google Maps.
3. Life's "turns" may lead us to something better than what we initially aimed for.
4. In the moment of failure, confidence dips, and self-doubt arises.
5. With time, detours often reveal unexpected beauty and opportunities.
6. The real issue is not failure itself but *society's rigid definition of it*.
7. Society typically equates success with *money, status, property, or followers*.
8. By this narrow definition, many people are wrongly branded as "unsuccessful."
9. The concept of zero shows that emptiness can be powerful — zero *amplifies value* when added to something.
10. Zero can symbolize a *reset or fresh start* rather than emptiness.
11. Success and failure are not final destinations or fixed labels.
12. Both are *fleeting, shifting, and evolving moments* in life.
13. Failure can bring *wisdom and growth*.
14. Success can bring *silence and reflection*.
15. We are neither our failures nor our successes — we are the *soul navigating through both*.

Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



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